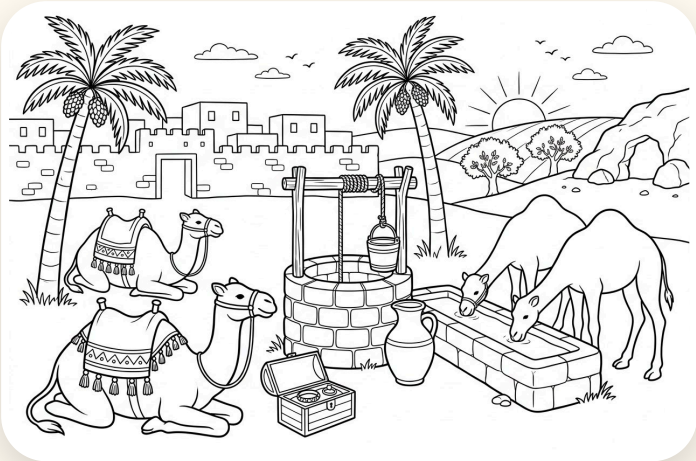
It Really Happened

A Thought on Parashat Chayei Sarah

Dvar Torah - a printable page



Dear children, in this week's parasha the Torah tells us that Avraham Avinu sends his servant Eliezer to Charan to find a wife for his son Yitzchak. But Eliezer asks Avraham what to do if the woman will not agree to leave her land. Should he take Yitzchak to her, so they can live there? Avraham says no. If she does not agree, Eliezer will be free of his oath - "only do not bring my son back there."

Rashi explains that only Yitzchak may not go back to Charan, but his son Yaakov will one day go back there. So we have to ask: if living in Charan is so bad, how can Yaakov go down there?

The answer is that we cannot compare the holy Avos, because each of the Avos had a different role and his own special way of serving Hashem. For example, the reason Yitzchak Avinu was not allowed to leave Eretz Yisrael was that he had been placed on the mizbeach at the Akeidah and was considered a perfect offering - and that was not true of Yaakov.

From here we can learn an important rule: many people try to live the way they see others living - but that is a mistake, because then we miss the special service that Hashem wants from us. Each of us has our own personal role. Every person needs to recognize their own place and see how they can grow and serve Hashem in the best way possible. Only from our own personal place can we truly serve Hashem.

Shabbat Shalom, and a blessed one!